



Windows 7

With Windows 7 on some of our older PCs, this seemed like as good a place to start as any

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While Windows 7 may be far better designed for speed than Vista, there are still times when you find yourself drumming your fingers on your desk waiting for something to happen. If you have slightly older hardware you'll face this more often, but hey even if you have decent gear nothing satisfies the performance junkie in you, right? Here's a set of tweaks that will kick your sluggish desktop into a performance PC.

Disable indexing

This feature provides content indexing, property caching, and search results for files, e-mail, and other content. However this consumes resources and if

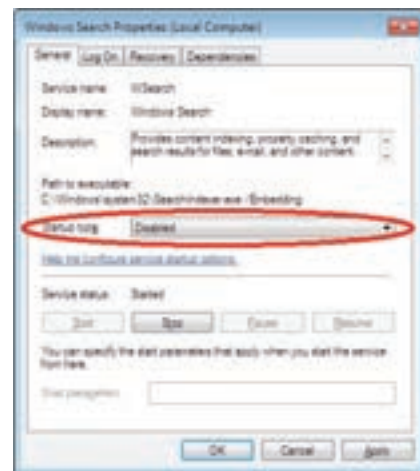
you're not one of those who uses the search feature a lot, you can easily disable it. Right-click Computer in the Start Menu and click on Manage. Next find the Services option under Services and Applications. Look for "Windows Search" in the list of services. Right-click and open properties for this service. Under start up type choose "Disabled".

Chuck out Aero

You needn't give up your beloved Aero eyecandy if you don't want to. But if you don't have a graphics card with compute power to spare it's usually recommended that you do. Right-click on the desktop and click Personalize. Now choose the Windows 7 basic or Windows Classic theme.

Use Ready Boost

If you have a 2GB (or more) Flash drive lying around, you can use it to speed up your computer using Windows ReadyBoost. Once you insert the Flash drive click on Speed up my system in the AutoPlay. Now you can choose to dedicate the entire drive or part of it to this function.



It is recommended that you use twice the capacity of your onboard RAM. This does provide some improvement in speed but it's in no way like adding 2 GB of RAM.

Turn off unused features

In the start menu simply type "Turn Windows features on or off". Click the result that comes under control panel. Here you'll see a list of features that are checked/unchecked. We recommend switching off Tablet PC features, Windows Gadgets Platform, etc.

Give it more juice

Click on power options in the Control Panel. Now under preferred plans you will find a Change Plan settings link next to the plan that is currently in use. Now click on Change Advanced Power Settings and use the drop down to select High Performance. This will give you the additional power needed to perform resource intensive tasks. The difference may not be noticeable on desktops but more on Laptops that are plugged into a powersource.

Services begone

Windows 7 has a lot of services that can quite safely be turned off without losing out on any functionality. Who the heck needs "Adaptive Brightness" anyway if you don't have ambient light sensors? To access services panel, and how to disable refer Disable Indexing tip above. However its

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